How to request precertification for an admission or get prior authorization for Other services

First, you, your representative, your physician, or your facility must call to obtain preauthorization before an Inpatient facility admission, Residential Treatment Center (RTC) admission, or for services requiring precertification/preauthorization are rendered. Refer to the back of your member ID card under the heading Prior Authorization for the contact information.

For admissions to Skilled Nursing Facility, Long-Term Acute Care, or Rehabilitation facilities, please refer to the back of your member ID card under the heading Prior Authorization for the contact information.

Next, provide the following information:

- enrollee's name and Plan identification number;
- patient's name, birth date, and phone number;
- reason for hospitalization, proposed treatment, or surgery;
- name and phone number of admitting physician;
- name of hospital or facility; and
- number of days requested for facility stay.

We will then tell the doctor and/or facility the number of approved inpatient days and we will send written confirmation of our decision to you, your doctor, and the facility.

- **Non-urgent care claims**

For non-urgent care claims, we will tell the physician and/or facilities the number of approved inpatient days, or the care that we approve for other services that must have prior authorization. We will make our decision within 15 days of receipt of the pre-service claim.

If matters beyond our control require an extension of time, we may take up to an additional 15 days for review and we will notify you of the need for an extension of time before the end of the original **15-day** period. Our notice will include the circumstances underlying the request for the extension and the date when a decision is expected.

If we need an extension because we have not received necessary information from you, our notice will describe the specific information required and we will allow you up to 60 days from the receipt of the notice to provide the information.

- **Urgent care claims**

If you have an **urgent care claim** (i.e., when waiting for the regular time limit for your medical care or treatment could seriously jeopardize your life, health, or ability to regain maximum function, or in the opinion of a physician with knowledge of your medical condition, would subject you to severe pain that cannot be adequately managed without this care or treatment), we will expedite our review and notify you of our decision within 72 hours. If you request that we review your claim as an urgent care claim, we will review the documentation you provide and decide whether or not it is an urgent care claim by applying the judgment of a prudent layperson that possesses an average knowledge of health and medicine.

If you fail to provide sufficient information, we will contact you within 24 hours after we receive the claim to let you know what information we need to complete our review of the claim. You will then have up to 48 hours to provide the required information. We will make our decision on the claim within 48 hours of (1) the time we received the additional information, or (2) the end of the time frame, whichever is earlier.

We may provide our decision orally within these time frames, but we will follow up with written or electronic notification within three days of oral notification.